

Absolutely — **talent** deserves a fairly deep entry because it has a strong core meaning but several important shifts in **countability**, **person-reference**, **organisational/business use**, **entertainment**, and **family extensions**.

I'm keeping the same standard as before: broad search first, then conservative sense-splitting. Your SOP specifically requires checks for countability shifts, part-of-speech changes, domain uses, compounds, and family extensions before finalizing.

Word family: **talent / talents / talented**

Base word: talent

Plural: talents

Related adjective: talented

Useful compounds / extensions: natural talent, raw talent, local talent, young talent, emerging talent, top talent, talent pool, talent pipeline, talent development, talent identification, talent management, talent acquisition, talent shortage, talent scout, talent agency, talent show

Part of speech: noun / adjective-related form

Your sentences

Your application contains two especially relevant uses:

> “What matters in high-performance sport is not **talent** alone, but the environment in which that talent is trained, tested and protected.”

and:

> “Equally important is the responsibility to identify and support local **talent**.”

Meaning in this passage

In both cases, **talent** refers to **natural or developed ability that gives someone the potential to perform especially well**, particularly in sport.

But there is a subtle difference:

“talent alone”

Here **talent** means:

ability/potential itself

“local talent”

Here **talent** refers collectively to:

****talented people / promising athletes****

That countability/reference shift is important.

****繁體中文：****

****talent — ability = 某人在某個領域具有的突出天賦、能力或發展潛質****

****local talent = 某個地區內具有突出能力或發展潛力的人才 / 有潛質的運動員****

1. talent — natural ability or aptitude — 天分；天賦；才能

This is the central meaning.

A ****talent**** is an ability someone seems naturally good at, or has unusually strong potential to develop.

Practice 1 — Original

> “What matters in high-performance sport is not ****talent**** alone.”

「在高水平運動中，重要的不只是運動員本身的****天分 / 天賦****。」

Practice 2

> “She showed exceptional ****talent**** for running at a young age.”

「她年紀很小時便展現出非凡的跑步****天分****。」

Practice 3

> “Natural ****talent**** helps, but disciplined training is also essential.”

「天然****天賦****固然有幫助，但有紀律的訓練同樣重要。」

****talent = 某人在某個領域天生或很早便顯示出的突出能力及發展潛質****

2. talent — developed skill or ability — 才能；能力

****Talent**** does not always mean something purely inborn.

It can also refer more broadly to a highly developed ability.

Practice 4

> “Years of training helped her develop her **talent**.”

「多年的訓練幫助她進一步發展自己的**才能**。」

Practice 5

> “His greatest **talent** is communicating with young athletes.”

「他最突出的**才能**是與年輕運動員溝通。」

talent = 某人在某方面表現特別出色的能力，這種能力可以是天生，也可以經過培養和發展

Curation note

I would **not** split “natural talent” and “developed talent” into completely unrelated meanings.

The shared concept remains:

> **unusually strong ability in a particular area**

The difference is mainly **source and development**.

3. a talent for + activity/skill — 做.....的天分；擅長.....

A very important grammatical construction.

Practice 6

> “She has a **talent for** motivating nervous athletes.”

「她很有**激勵緊張運動員的天分**。」

Practice 7

> “He has a natural **talent for** languages.”

「他有學習語言的天然**天賦**。」

have a talent for something = 在某項活動或能力方面特別有天分 / 特別擅長

4. talent — particular ability considered as one of several — 才能；特長

Here **talent** is countable.

Someone can have:

* a talent

* several talents

* many talents

Practice 8

> “One of her greatest **talents** is staying calm under pressure.”

「她其中一項最大的**才能**是在壓力下保持冷靜。」

Practice 9

> “He has many **talents**, including coaching and event organisation.”

「他有很多**才能 / 特長**，包括教練工作和活動籌辦。」

a talent / talents = 某人所具備的一項或多項特別能力 / 特長

Important countability distinction

talent — ability generally

often uncountable:

> “She has talent.”

= 她很有才華 / 天分。

a talent

countable:

> “She has a talent for leadership.”

= 她在領導方面有天分。

talents

plural:

> “Her talents include writing and coaching.”

= 她的才能包括寫作和教練工作。

This is excellent MCQ material.

5. talent — talented person/people collectively — 人才；有才華的人

This is the meaning in:

> “identify and support local **talent**”

Here, **talent** no longer refers only to an abstract ability.

It refers to **people who possess that ability**.

Practice 10 — Passage sense

> “The Foundation aims to identify and support local **talent**.”

「基金會旨在發掘和支援本地**人才 / 有潛質的運動員**。」

Practice 11

> “The academy is known for developing young **talent**.”

「這所學院以培養年輕**人才**聞名。」

Practice 12

> “The company is trying to attract international **talent**.”

「公司正努力吸引國際**人才**。」

****talent = 具有突出能力、專業技能或發展潛質的人才群體****

This is a major modern business/sport/media meaning.

6. local talent — 本地人才；本地有潛質者

Directly relevant to your passage.

Practice 13

> “The programme was created to develop local **talent**.”

「這項計劃旨在培養本地**人才**。」

Practice 14

> “Several local talents joined the national training squad.”

Careful: in ordinary professional English, **local talent** as a collective noun is often more natural than **local talents** when referring to people generally.

Better:

> “Several talented local athletes joined the national training squad.”

「幾名有潛質的本地運動員加入了國家訓練隊。」

local talent = 某個地區內具有能力、潛力或專業價值的人才

7. young talent / emerging talent — 年輕人才；新秀

A very common sports, business, and entertainment use.

Practice 15

> “The club invests heavily in young **talent**.”

「俱樂部投入大量資源培養年輕**人才**。」

Practice 16

> “The festival gives emerging **talent** a chance to perform.”

「這個節慶給予新晉**人才**演出的機會。」

young/emerging talent = 尚在發展階段但已顯示出明顯潛力的人才

8. raw talent — 未經雕琢的天分；原始潛質

A particularly useful phrase for your sports passage.

Practice 17

> “The coach immediately noticed her **raw talent**.”

「教練立即注意到她**尚未經充分訓練、但非常明顯的天分**。」

Practice 18

> “Raw talent is not enough without discipline and coaching.”

「只有**原始天賦**並不足夠，還需要紀律和教練指導。」

raw talent = 尚未經過充分訓練或打磨，但已明顯存在的自然能力 / 潛質

This is especially relevant to:

> “students with raw speed, courage and curiosity”

in your passage, although the exact word **talent** is not used there.

9. top talent — 頂尖人才

Very common in business, sport, entertainment, and recruitment.

Practice 19

> “The organisation wants to attract top **talent**.”

「該機構希望吸引**頂尖人才**。」

Practice 20

> “Strong organisations know how to retain top talent.”

「優秀的機構懂得如何留住**頂尖人才**。」

top talent = 在某個行業、專業或能力領域中表現最出色的一批人才

10. talent — workforce/recruitment people resource — 人才資源

In HR and business English, **talent** is frequently used as a collective term for employees or potential employees with valuable skills.

Practice 21

> “The company needs more technology **talent**.”

「公司需要更多科技**人才**。」

Practice 22

> “Competition for skilled **talent** is increasing.”

「企業之間爭奪高技能**人才**的競爭正在加劇。」

talent = 對組織具有專業技能、能力或發展價值的人力資源 / 人才

This has become a very important modern professional use.

11. talent pool — 人才庫；人才群

A group of people available or suitable for recruitment, development, or selection.

Practice 23

> “The programme creates a larger **talent pool** for elite sport.”

「這項計劃為精英體育建立更大的**人才庫 / 人才群**。」

Practice 24

> “The company wants to broaden its international talent pool.”

「公司希望擴大其國際**人才庫**。」

talent pool = 可供選拔、招聘、培養或晉升的一群具備相關能力的人

12. talent pipeline — 人才梯隊；人才供應管道

Common in business and elite sport.

Practice 25

> “School outreach helps strengthen the sporting **talent pipeline**.”

「學校外展工作有助加強體育**人才梯隊**。」

Practice 26

> “The company is building a stronger leadership talent pipeline.”

「公司正在建立更完善的領導**人才梯隊**。」

****talent pipeline = 從發掘、培養到最終進入較高水平職位 / 競技層級的一整套人才來源和發展渠道****

Very relevant to your source passage.

13. talent development — 人才培養；才能發展

Directly relevant to coaching.

Practice 27

> “The Foundation places strong emphasis on ****talent development****.”

「基金會非常重視****人才培養****。」

Practice 28

> “Effective talent development requires long-term planning.”

「有效的****人才發展 / 培養****需要長期規劃。」

****talent development = 透過訓練、教育、經驗和支援，持續提升有潛質人士的能力****

14. talent identification — 人才識別；人才發掘

Extremely relevant to your passage:

> “identify and support local talent”

Practice 29

> “The academy uses school competitions for ****talent identification****.”

「學院透過校際比賽進行****人才發掘****。」

Practice 30

> “Talent identification should consider long-term potential, not only early results.”

「**人才識別 / 發掘**不應只看早期成績，也應考慮長期潛力。」

talent identification = 系統地找出具有較高能力或未來發展潛力的人

15. talent management — 人才管理

A major HR/business compound.

Practice 31

> “Effective **talent management** helps retain strong employees.”

「有效的**人才管理**有助留住優秀員工。」

Practice 32

> “The organisation introduced a new talent management strategy.”

「該機構推出了新的**人才管理策略**。」

talent management = 招聘、培養、評估、晉升和留住有能力員工的一整套人力資源管理做法

16. talent acquisition — 人才招募；人才招聘

A modern HR term often broader/more strategic than simple **recruitment**.

Practice 33

> “She works in **talent acquisition**.”

「她從事**人才招募 / 人才招聘**工作。」

Practice 34

> “The firm expanded its talent acquisition team.”

「公司擴充了**人才招聘團隊**。」

****talent acquisition = 有策略地尋找、吸引及招聘具有所需能力的人才****

17. talent shortage — 人才短缺

Practice 35

> “The industry is facing a serious ****talent shortage****.”

「該行業正面對嚴重的****人才短缺****。」

Practice 36

> “Training programmes can help address the talent shortage.”

「培訓計劃可以幫助改善****人才不足****問題。」

****talent shortage = 某個行業或組織缺乏足夠具備所需能力的人才****

18. talent scout — 星探；人才發掘者

A person whose job is to find promising performers, athletes, models, or other talented people.

Practice 37

> “A ****talent scout**** noticed her at a junior competition.”

「一名****人才發掘員 / 星探****在青少年比賽中注意到她。」

Practice 38

> “The club employs talent scouts across the region.”

「俱樂部在各地聘用****人才發掘人員****。」

****talent scout = 專門尋找具有突出能力或發展潛質人士的人****

Sports translation

In sport:

****人才發掘員 / 球探****

may be more natural than **星探**.

19. talent agency — 藝人經紀公司；人才代理機構

Especially common in entertainment.

Practice 39

> “She signed with a major **talent agency**.”

「她與一家大型**藝人經紀公司**簽約。」

Practice 40

> “The talent agency represents actors and musicians.”

「該**藝人經紀公司**代理演員和音樂人。」

talent agency = 代表並安排演藝、模特或其他表演人才工作的專業代理公司

This is a lexicalized entertainment-industry compound.

20. talent agent — 藝人經紀人

A person who represents performers and helps secure work, contracts, or opportunities.

Practice 41

> “Her **talent agent** negotiated the contract.”

「她的**藝人經紀人**協商了合約。」

Practice 42

> “A talent agent introduced him to several producers.”

「一名**藝人經紀人**把他介紹給幾位製作人。」

21. talent show — 才藝表演；才藝比賽

An event or television programme where participants demonstrate skills such as:

- * singing
- * dancing
- * comedy
- * magic
- * performance

Practice 43

> “She won the school **talent show**.”

「她贏得了學校的**才藝表演比賽**。」

Practice 44

> “The television talent show attracted millions of viewers.”

「這個電視**才藝比賽節目**吸引了數百萬觀眾。」

talent show = 參加者展示唱歌、舞蹈、表演等才能的比賽 / 節目

22. talented — having strong ability — 有才華的；有天分的

The most important direct adjective.

Practice 45

> “She is a highly **talented** young athlete.”

「她是一名非常**有天分的**年輕運動員。」

Practice 46

> “The team includes several talented designers.”

「團隊中有幾名很**有才華的**設計師。」

talented = 在某個領域具有明顯突出能力或天分的

23. talented at/in + activity/field — 在……方面有才華

Practice 47

> “He is particularly **talented at** explaining difficult ideas.”

「他特別**擅長**解釋困難的概念。」

Practice 48

> “She is talented in both sport and music.”

「她在運動和音樂方面都很**有才華**。」

****talented at/in = 在某個技能、活動或領域中具有較突出能力****

24. talent — entertainment performers collectively — 演藝人才；藝人

In film, television, advertising, and production, ****the talent**** can refer collectively to performers, presenters, actors, models, or on-screen/on-air people.

Practice 49

> “The production team arranged transport for the ****talent****.”

「製作團隊為參與演出的****藝人 / 演出人員****安排交通。」

Practice 50

> “All talent must arrive on set by eight.”

「所有****演出人員 / 藝人****都必須在八時前到達拍攝現場。」

****the talent = 影視、廣告或娛樂製作中負責出鏡、演出或主持的人員****

This is a genuinely useful industry-specific meaning.

It is different from saying:

> “She has talent.”

25. talent — attractive people, informal/slang — 有吸引力的人

There is also an informal, sometimes dated use of **talent** referring collectively to attractive people, especially potential romantic interests.

Example:

> “He was looking around at the local talent.”

This can sound objectifying and dated depending on context.

Under your Golden Manual standard, I would **flag** it as informal/datable but not prioritize it for active learner production.

talent — informal = 被視為有吸引力、可能成為約會對象的人

Useful for recognition, lower priority for use.

Important distinctions

talent vs skill

This is one of the most important distinctions.

talent

often suggests:

- * natural aptitude
- * unusual potential
- * strong ability

skill

usually emphasizes:

- * learned ability
- * training
- * practice
- * competence in doing something

> “She has natural talent.”

「她有天然天分。」

> “She developed strong technical skills.”

「她培養了很強的技術能力。」

A person can have:

****talent without much training****

or:

****skill developed through training****

although in real life they often interact.

talent vs ability

ability

very broad:

> capacity to do something

talent

usually implies:

> notably strong or promising ability

Everyone may have the ****ability**** to learn something, but only some may show exceptional ****talent**** for it.

talent vs potential

Very relevant to your passage.

talent

= ability already visible to some degree

potential

= capacity to develop or succeed in the future

A young athlete can have:

- * raw talent;
- * high potential;

but the two are not identical.

****Talent is evidence of ability.**

Potential is what that ability may become.******

talent vs gifted

talented

= having strong ability

gifted

often suggests exceptionally high natural ability

> “a talented musician”

broad praise

> “a gifted musician”

often stronger, emphasizing unusual natural ability

talent vs genius

talent

strong ability

genius

exceptionally rare intellectual or creative ability, or a person possessing it

So ****genius**** is much stronger than ****talent****.

talent vs expertise

talent

ability/potential

expertise

deep knowledge and skill developed through study and experience

A talented beginner may have little expertise.

An expert may have developed expertise through years of work, regardless of whether people describe them as naturally talented.

talent vs experience

talent

what someone is capable of doing particularly well

experience

what someone has learned through actually doing things over time

Your passage itself makes this distinction nicely: athletic ability and accumulated professional experience are both valuable, but they are not the same.

talent vs personnel/staff

In business:

talent

often positively frames employees in terms of value, potential, or capability

staff/personnel

simply identifies the people working for an organisation

So:

> “We need more staff.”

means more employees.

> “We need more talent.”

often means more **capable/skilled employees**.

talent vs candidate

candidate

person being considered for a role

talent

person valued for their ability/potential

A recruiter might say:

> “We have three strong candidates.”

during selection,

but:

> “We need to attract better talent.”

when discussing the overall workforce market.

Important countability note

This family is especially useful because **talent changes between countable and uncountable usage**.

Uncountable — ability

> “She has great talent.”

「她很有天分。」

Countable — one particular ability

> “She has a talent for languages.”

「她有語言天分。」

Plural — several abilities

> “She has many talents.”

「她有很多才能。」

Collective people use

> “The company wants to attract talent.”

「公司希望吸引人才。」

Here **talent** behaves collectively and commonly appears without a plural ending.

This distinction deserves explicit teaching.

Family-extension sweep

After the full ordinary, sporting, business, HR, entertainment, countability, compound, and second-pass audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **talent — ability** = 天分 / 才能
- * **a talent for** = 在.....方面有天分
- * **talents — individual abilities** = 多項才能
- * **talent — people collectively** = 人才
- * **local talent** = 本地人才
- * **young talent** = 年輕人才
- * **emerging talent** = 新晉人才
- * **raw talent** = 未經雕琢的天賦
- * **top talent** = 頂尖人才
- * **talent pool** = 人才庫
- * **talent pipeline** = 人才梯隊 / 供應渠道
- * **talent development** = 人才培養
- * **talent identification** = 人才發掘
- * **talent management** = 人才管理
- * **talent acquisition** = 人才招募
- * **talent shortage** = 人才短缺
- * **talent scout** = 人才發掘員 / 星探
- * **talent agent** = 藝人經紀人

* **talent agency** = 藝人經紀公司
 * **talent show** = 才藝比賽 / 節目
 * **talented** = 有才華 / 天分的
 * **the talent — media** = 演出人員 / 藝人
 * **talent — informal attractive people** = 有吸引力的人，較口語且可能帶物化語氣

I would stop there. There are specialized institutional uses beyond this, but they would mostly be transparent combinations rather than genuinely useful additions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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talent — natural/developed ability	某人在某個領域表現突出或具有特別發展潛質的能力 / 天分
a talent for something	在某項活動、技能或領域中特別有天分或特長
talents — individual abilities	某人所具備的多項特別才能或特長
talent — people collectively	具有突出能力、專業技能或發展潛質的人才群體
local talent	某個地區內具有能力或發展潛質的人才
young/emerging talent	尚在發展階段但已顯示明顯潛力的人才
raw talent	尚未經充分訓練或打磨，但已明顯顯示出的自然能力
top talent	某個專業或領域中能力最突出的一批人才
talent pool	可供招聘、選拔、培養或晉升的一群具備相關能力的人
talent pipeline	從人才發掘、培養到進入更高層級的一整套人才來源和發展渠道
talent development	透過訓練、教育和支援持續提升有潛質人士能力的過程
talent identification	系統地找出具有較高能力或未來發展潛力的人
talent management	招聘、培養、評估、晉升及留住有能力人才的一整套管理做法
talent acquisition	有策略地尋找、吸引和招聘具有所需技能的人才
talent shortage	某行業 / 機構缺乏足夠具備所需能力的人才
talent scout	專門尋找具有突出能力或發展潛質人士的人
talent agency	代表並安排演藝或表演人才工作的專業代理公司
talent show	參加者展示唱歌、舞蹈、表演等才能的比賽或節目
talented	在某個領域具有明顯突出能力或天分的
the talent — entertainment	影視、廣告或娛樂製作中的演員、主持人、模特等演出人員

For your original passage

> “What matters in high-performance sport is not **talent** alone...”

The exact meaning is:

****talent = 運動員本身具有的突出能力、天分和發展潛質****

So:

> **talent alone**

= **單靠本身的天分 / 才能**

But in:

> “identify and support local **talent**”

the meaning shifts slightly:

talent = 具有運動能力和發展潛質的人才 / 年輕運動員

So naturally:

> **local talent = 本地有潛質的運動人才**

That **abstract ability → talented people collectively** shift is the most important polysemy distinction in your passage.